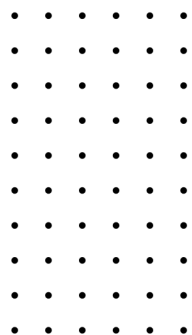


20 Essential Phrases for IELTS Speaking

KEITH O'HARE



Helping you Become a Confident English Speaker

Many IELTS students lack confidence in their speaking skills.

The Keith Speaking Academy helps you develop your speaking skills so you can face the examiner with confidence and ace the IELTS test.

This PDF is one of many that Keith has developed to help you do this.



Keith has been working in international education for over 20 years as a teacher, teacher trainer, and education manager.

He has helped over 40,000 students prepare for their IELTS Speaking test with his online courses.

In this lesson, I will help you boost your IELTS Speaking score with **20 essential phrases** for the most common topics in IELTS Speaking.

I know some students struggle in IELTS speaking because they just get lots of model answers, read them aloud and memorise them.

What they are **not** doing is learning the pronunciation and intonation, which means they don't sound very natural.

Students who succeed in IELTS Speaking have learnt to sound natural, with correct pronunciation, intonation and phrasing.

In this lesson you will learn how to do that, so you sound more natural, and can then ace your IELTS test.

Oh yes, and at the end of the lesson, I will give you some tips on what to say when you don't understand a question or you just have no idea what to say in the IELTS speaking test.

Let's get going!

How to use this lesson

Watch the video of this lesson here: *(add link once uploaded)*

Repeat with me, follow my **pronunciation, intonation** and **phrasing**.
Pause the video if necessary, to give yourself time to repeat and practice.

Where I put the word in [brackets], then you have to substitute with your own word for your context.

Words you could stress are underlined.

For example:

Keith: My name is [Keith O'Hare]

You: My name is [your name]

Keith: My name is [Keith O'Hare], but just call me [Keith]

Pablo Gonzalez: My name is [Pablo Gonzalez], but just call me [Pablo]

1. Where You Live

- I am from [Manchester] born and bred
- I live in [Spain] and I've been living here for a number of years
- I live in [Spain] and I've lived here all my life

Notes:

Born and bred /bɔ:n ən bred/ = born and raised

Present Perfect Continuous (*action began in past and continues now*)

- I have been living here - **I've been** /aɪv bi:n/

A number of years = some years

Present Perfect Simple (*action began in past and continues now*)

- I have lived

2. Work

- I work as a [teacher] and I've been one for quite a while
- I find my work challenging but rewarding because [...]
- My typical workday involves [preparing online classes]

Notes:

I work as a **/aɪ wɜ:kəzə/**

Quite a while = quite a long time

Challenging (adj.) = difficult

Rewarding (adj.) = gives satisfaction

3. Hobbies and Free Time

- I don't get up to much in my free time.
- I recently got into [yoga] and I am really enjoying it now.
- I'm considering taking up [the drums] it's something I've always wanted to do

Notes:

To **get up to** = to do

To **get into something** = to become interested in an activity / hobby

To **consider** = to think about (doing something)

To **take up** = to begin a hobby

4. Family

- I'm from a close-knit family.
- I get on well with my [brother] although we do have our moments
- I'm probably closest to my [grandmother] we just click

Notes:

When speaking, we usually use **contractions**

- I am = **I'm**
- It is = **It's**
- I have = **I've**

Close-knit (adj.) /**kləʊs'nɪt**/ = people who are close and supportive

To get on (with s.o.) = to have a good relationship

We have our moments = we have our disagreements / ups and downs

5. Health and Fitness

- I'm a firm believer in doing daily exercise
- I strive to eat a healthy diet, although I don't always pull it off
- I've not had any serious illnesses to date, touch wood!

Notes:

firm (adj.) = strong

To strive = to try hard

To pull something off = to do successfully

To date = until now

Touch wood = said to avoid bad luck!

6. Travel

- If I could, I'd love to travel to [Nigeria]
- I'd jump at the chance to visit [Vietnam], I think it'd be so [interesting]

Notes:

2nd Conditional

- If I could, I would love to...

To jump at the chance = to eagerly take the opportunity

7. Giving opinions

Do you think it's a good idea to give children a mobile phone?

I think it's a bad idea

- The way I see it ____
- To my mind ____
- I would have to say ____

8. When you don't fully understand

- Sorry could you repeat that?
- Can you explain what you mean exactly?
- Could you elaborate on that?

Notes:

Could_you / kʊdʒu: /

To elaborate = to give more details

Summary

Many of the techniques used in this lesson are from **Step 3** of the **Speaking Success System**.

This is a system I have developed over years of teaching and it is at the heart of my online course:

IELTS Speaking Success - Get a Band 7+ GOLD

There are 4 steps:

1. Try
2. Discover
3. Practice
4. Build

Step 3 is **Practice** which involves practicing small chunks of language in different ways.

These include repeating, changing tense, saying the opposite and so on.

You can find out about this system and actually start using it when you join the **IELTS Speaking Success GOLD course**.

IELTS SPEAKING SUCCESS GOLD COURSE.

